

PRISMA 2020 checklist

Ferric derisomaltose versus ferric carboxymaltose: a systematic review and meta-analysis of head-to-head randomised controlled trials

Locations refer to sections, tables and figures of the manuscript; repository paths refer to <https://github.com/filippobuscemi11463-sketch/FDI-FCM-metaanalysis>.

Section / topic	Item	Checklist item	Location
TITLE			
Title	1	Identify the report as a systematic review.	Title
ABSTRACT			
Abstract	2	See the PRISMA 2020 for Abstracts checklist.	Abstract (Background, Methods, Results, Conclusions, Registration; funding in Declarations)
INTRODUCTION			
Rationale	3	Describe the rationale for the review in the context of existing knowledge.	Section 1, paragraphs 1–2
Objectives	4	Provide an explicit statement of the objective(s) or question(s) the review addresses.	Section 1, paragraph 3
METHODS			
Eligibility criteria	5	Specify the inclusion and exclusion criteria and how studies were grouped for the syntheses.	Section 2.2; grouping by outcome and threshold in 2.3
Information sources	6	Specify all databases, registers, websites, organisations, reference lists and other sources searched or consulted, with the date last searched.	Section 2.4
Search strategy	7	Present the full search strategies for all databases, registers and websites, including any filters and limits used.	Repository: 99-Meta/queries.yaml, 99-Meta/log/ma-ricerca-2026-09-29.md; unused strings in 99-Meta/ricerca-manuale-meta.md
Selection process	8	Methods used to decide whether a study met the inclusion criteria, including reviewers, independence and automation tools.	Sections 2.5 and 2.10; criteria in 99-Meta/criteri-screening-meta.md
Data collection process	9	Methods used to collect data, including reviewers, independence, confirmation of data and automation tools.	Sections 2.6 and 2.10; codebook 99-Meta/estrazione-meta.md
Data items	10a	List and define all outcomes for which data were sought.	Section 2.3
	10b	List and define all other variables for which data were sought.	Section 2.6; Table 2; codebook 99-Meta/estrazione-meta.md
Study risk of bias assessment	11	Methods used to assess risk of bias, including tool, reviewers, independence and automation tools.	Sections 2.7 and 2.10
Effect measures	12	Specify the effect measure(s) used for each outcome.	Section 2.8 (dichotomous and continuous outcomes)
Synthesis methods	13a	Processes used to decide which studies were eligible for each synthesis.	Section 2.3 (threshold rule); Section 2.8 (pooling rules)
	13b	Methods required to prepare the data for synthesis.	Sections 2.6 and 2.8 (zero cells, no derivation of counts from percentages)
	13c	Methods used to tabulate or visually display results.	Tables 2–4; Figure 2
	13d	Methods used to synthesise results and rationale; model, heterogeneity methods and software.	Section 2.8
	13e	Methods used to explore possible causes of heterogeneity.	Section 2.8 (Subgroups)
	13f	Sensitivity analyses conducted.	Section 2.8 (Sensitivity analyses)
Reporting bias assessment	14	Methods used to assess risk of bias due to missing results.	Section 2.8 (Publication bias)
Certainty assessment	15	Methods used to assess certainty in the body of evidence.	Section 2.9
RESULTS			
Study selection	16a	Results of the search and selection process, ideally with a flow diagram.	Section 3.1; Figure 1

Section / topic	Item	Checklist item	Location
	16b	Cite studies that might appear to meet the inclusion criteria but were excluded, and explain why.	Section 3.1 (excluded reports by reason, awaiting classification); per-record decisions in <code>99-Meta/db/record-meta.csv</code> ; evidence sheets in <code>99-Meta/log/eleggibilita/</code>
Study characteristics	17	Cite each included study and present its characteristics.	Section 3.2; Table 2
Risk of bias in studies	18	Present assessments of risk of bias for each included study.	Section 3.3; Table 3; signalling questions in <code>30-Dati/ma-rob2.csv</code>
Results of individual studies	19	For all outcomes, present summary statistics for each group and an effect estimate with its precision for each study.	Figure 2; Sections 3.4–3.6; arm-level rows in <code>30-Dati/ma-bracci.csv</code> ; all forest plots in <code>50-Metanalisi/output/</code>
Results of syntheses	20a	Briefly summarise characteristics and risk of bias among contributing studies for each synthesis.	Sections 3.3–3.6
	20b	Present results of all statistical syntheses with precision and heterogeneity measures.	Sections 3.4–3.6; Figure 2; Table 4
	20c	Present results of all investigations of possible causes of heterogeneity.	Section 3.4 (subgroups)
	20d	Present results of all sensitivity analyses.	Sections 3.4–3.5; complete output in <code>50-Metanalisi/output/</code>
Reporting biases	21	Present assessments of risk of bias due to missing results for each synthesis.	Section 3.7
Certainty of evidence	22	Present assessments of certainty in the body of evidence for each outcome.	Section 3.8; Table 4; <code>50-Metanalisi/grade.md</code>
DISCUSSION			
Discussion	23a	General interpretation of the results in the context of other evidence.	Sections 4.1–4.2
	23b	Limitations of the evidence included in the review.	Section 4.3 (Limitations)
	23c	Limitations of the review processes used.	Section 4.3 (Limitations)
	23d	Implications for practice, policy and future research.	Section 4.4
OTHER INFORMATION			
Registration and protocol	24a	Registration information, or a statement that the review was not registered.	Abstract (Registration); Section 2.1 (not registered)
	24b	Where the review protocol can be accessed, or a statement that a protocol was not prepared.	Section 2.1; frozen version <code>99-Meta/protocollo-metanalisi-v1.0-fc19a3</code> current version with deviation log <code>99-Meta/protocollo-metanalisi.md</code>
	24c	Describe and explain any amendments to information provided at registration or in the protocol.	Table 1; deviation log in <code>99-Meta/protocollo-metanalisi.md</code> , section 15
Support	25	Sources of financial or non-financial support and the role of funders or sponsors.	Declarations (Funding)
Competing interests	26	Declare any competing interests of review authors.	Declarations (Competing interests)
Availability of data, code and other materials	27	Report which materials are publicly available and where they can be found.	Declarations (Data and code availability)

From: Page MJ, McKenzie JE, Bossuyt PM, et al. The PRISMA 2020 statement: an updated guideline for reporting systematic reviews. *BMJ* 2021;372:n71. doi:10.1136/bmj.n71. Item wording abridged.